

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.64 — Analyze the impact of prosperity and consumerism in the 1950s, including the growth of white-collar jobs, the “suburban ideal,” the impacts of and disproportionate access to the G.I. Bill, and the increased reliance on foreign oil.

US.66 — Describe domestic developments during Dwight D. Eisenhower's administration, including: • Polio vaccine • Interstate Highway System • Growth of suburbia • Hotel chains • Fast food chains

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Analyze the following three primary sources. For each document, apply the HIPPA framework (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view). Then construct a written argument that addresses the central question: To what extent did the legal dismantling of 'separate but equal' between 1954 and 1957 translate into actual desegregation on the ground?

The sources

Document 1

Excerpt from *Brown v. Board of Education*, 347 U.S. 483 (1954). Source: National Archives, [archives.gov](https://www.archives.gov).

“We conclude that, in the field of public education, the doctrine of 'separate but equal' has no place. Separate educational facilities are inherently unequal. Therefore, we hold that the plaintiffs... are deprived of the equal protection of the laws guaranteed by the Fourteenth Amendment... We have now announced that such segregation is a denial of the equal protection of the laws.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

Document 2

Excerpt from the 'Declaration of Constitutional Principles' (Southern Manifesto), signed by 101 members of Congress, March 12, 1956. Source: Congressional Record, 84th Congress, 2nd Session, Vol. 102, Part 4 (March 12, 1956), pp. 4459–4460; National Archives, archives.gov.

“We regard the decision of the Supreme Court in the school cases as a clear abuse of judicial power... The original Constitution does not mention education. Neither does the 14th Amendment nor any other amendment... This unwarranted exercise of power by the Court, contrary to the Constitution, is creating chaos and confusion in the States principally affected... We pledge ourselves to use all lawful means to bring about a reversal of this decision which is contrary to the Constitution and to prevent the use of force in its implementation.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 3

Excerpt from President Dwight D. Eisenhower's Executive Order 10730, authorizing the use of federal troops to enforce school integration in Little Rock, Arkansas, September 24, 1957. Source: Executive Order 10730, Code of Federal Regulations, Title 3 (1957); National Archives, [archives.gov](https://www.archives.gov).

“WHEREAS certain persons in the state of Arkansas... have wilfully obstructed the enforcement of orders of the United States District Court for the Eastern District of Arkansas with regard to matters relating to enrollment and attendance at public schools... NOW, THEREFORE, by virtue of the authority vested in me by the Constitution and Statutes of the United States... it is hereby ordered as follows: The Secretary of Defense is authorized and directed to use the armed forces of the United States as he may deem necessary to enforce any orders of the United States District Court.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Using all three documents and your knowledge of the period, construct a multi-paragraph argument that analyzes: (1) the gap between legal authority (Document 1) and practical resistance (Document 2), (2) what the executive response (Document 3) reveals about the enforcement mechanisms available to translate legal principle into social reality, and (3) what these three documents together suggest about the relationship between judicial, legislative, and executive power in advancing or resisting civil rights.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

